plug some important gaps in the fighting around Bridge 2 on the Dirang–Se-la axis.

I am particularly indebted to Honorary Captain Dashrath Singh for giving me a ground level perspective of what happened at Nam Ka Chu. This session perhaps prepared me to ask Major General D. K. Palit relevant questions. The general was extremely forthcoming and blunt, even while commenting about his own perceived negative role. Others who I had the occasion to interview and interact with over the decades include H. C. Sarin, the then additional secretary in the Ministry of Defence. I also spoke to Field Marshal Sam Manekshaw, who finally brought about a semblance of sanity when he took over from Lieutenant General Bijji Kaul as the corps commander in Tezpur by issuing a brief statement: 'Gentlemen, there shall be no further withdrawals without my order. And that order shall never be given.'

Among those who fought as young officers and whose recollections have helped in shaping the book are Brigadiers Darshan Khullar who was at Se-la and Amar Jit Singh 'Tiger' Behl who was manning the gun position at Tsangdhar overlooking the Nam Ka Chu Valley. Wing Commander M. Sadatulla who lucidly described the fighting in Tsangdhar as seen from the air and Kaul's last moments in Tezpur, Major Kulwant Singh of 4 Sikh who was wounded in Walong, Major General A. K. 'Chicki' Dewan who commanded the 20 Lancers troop of AMX-13 tanks at Chushul, Lieutenant General Baljeet Singh who was a part of Operation Onkar in the Kumaon Hills, and many others gave me useful insights over the years through their conversations with me as well as published articles.

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